

FOUR-POINT PLAN FOR TIMELY REDEVELOPMENT

► **Unified, publicly accessible digital land inventory**

► **Standardised disposal frameworks: Clear guidelines on valuation, eligibility criteria, and development obligations to bring predictability**

► **Faster inter-agency approvals: Time-bound, single-window clearance systems with defined accountability, institutional co-ordination for alignment between land-owning bodies and urban development agencies**

► **Transparency and process efficiency as enablers**

SOURCE C. K. ISRANI

categories because access raises land prices. In the case of Navi Mumbai, since the intrinsic land value was unlocked for a social cause through municipal intervention, it could be used for affordable housing.

In Delhi, DLF's 38-acre land parcel on the fringes of central Delhi has a current value of ₹24,000 per sq ft. The One Midtown project, in collaboration with GIC of Singapore, sold ₹1,500 crore worth of inventory within days of launch in 2022. It also benefited from various social and infrastructure projects such as metro and rail connectivity and flyovers, as well as schools and hospitals.

LARGER PICTURE

What does it take to make this a reality in other towns and cit-

ies? It starts with political will and structured planning. In the Kathputli colony near Shadipur Bus Depot in Delhi, poor planning and unclear strategies made it a political hot potato for the ruling government.

Aggregating individual projects to create scale is what planned redevelopment is all about, says Amit Sathe of Meghna Realty. "Most of the roads in Bombay are just six metres, nine metres, 12 metres wide at best. There's a rule now that every road has to be nine metres."

Getting it done is a task in itself. When a redevelopment happens, the developer, along with the Brihanmumbai Municipal Council (BMC), makes that happen. "When road widening occurs, developers receive a

higher Floor Space Index. And by taking that initiative, the entire area improves because the road is widened, the traffic is better, things get better," he says.

THE GAINS

Steady volumes keep the business model alive for decades, and the new players come with the promise of efficient completion. Sheth says there are tangible benefits from this redevelopment.

"Not only does the new real estate get an advantage, but because of displacement, there's a lot of rental consumption that happens in that area. In the last five years, the number of renters in Bandra has increased by nearly 100%. So, a 1 BHK, which used to be available for ₹4,550 per sq ft, is now being rented out at ₹90,000. So automatic appreciation of real estate has happened. Similarly, the Versova market jumped from ₹35,000-40,000 per sq ft to about ₹80,000 per sq ft within a couple of years of the sea link announcement taking place."

The proof of CIDCO's success is that it has now launched the 2026 edition of its affordable housing project. Its track record of delivery gives buyers confidence. And costs in the range of ₹25-₹97 lakh are affordable in a city like Mumbai.

Contractor believes this is a model replicable across cities. For cities like Pune, Bengaluru and Chennai, which are upgrading their metro infrastructure, Mumbai's model of completing existing projects to unlock the value of land becomes a format that works. **BT**